

KIT 6 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF · RUN KITS 1 AND 2 FIRST

# AI for Communication: Parent Messages, Translation, and Tone

Everything you need before you present. Read this once (about 8 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist, and you're ready.

## What this session is

The session takes AI to the most visible surface of teaching: what goes home. Staff learn what AI genuinely does well in family communication (drafts, tone repair, reading level, reformatting) and the one thing it threatens (their voice), work through three makeovers on Ms. Rivera's screen (the newsletter, the difficult email, the positive-note batch), and get the responsible-translation rules most PD never covers. The 19-minute lab produces three real deliverables: **next week's actual family message, drafted and voiced; a positive-note batch started; and a translation access plan for their actual roster.**

### THE STANCE: REPEAT IT UNTIL IT'S FURNITURE

**AI drafts the message; the teacher makes it theirs. Families hear the teacher, not the tool. And hard news is never delivered by a draft: you call.**

Why the stakes are worth it: one individualized sentence home per week cut course-credit failure by 41% in a field experiment (Kraft & Rogers, 2015); 5.3 million U.S. students are English learners whose families federal guidance says must be reached in a language they understand (NCES; ED/DOJ 2015); and communication drafting is among the most common uses behind the ~5.9 hours/week that weekly AI users save (Gallup, 2025).

## Who should present it

Same bar as Kits 1–5: any confident colleague. You don't need to be a communications expert; the makeovers are fully scripted and the translation rules are written to be read aloud. What you must hold firmly is the human-only list on slide 16: safety, discipline, grief, and special-education news travel by voice, never by draft. If the room pushes for efficiency there, the answer is warm and immovable.

**One prep item matters most:** the pre-session email. The lab drafts a real message, so staff must arrive knowing what they owe families this week (newsletter, unit update, event reminder). Second item: if your district has a translation office, protocol, or approved tool, know its name; slide 14 routes official documents there, and you'll be asked. Third: add an empty "Communication" heading to the staff prompt doc from Kit 2.

## The session at a glance

| Segment                       | Minutes   | What happens                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Welcome & why messages matter | 0:00–0:05 | The margin problem; Kraft & Rogers' one-sentence finding                         |
| The tool and the voice        | 0:05–0:12 | What AI does well here; the beige risk; the two permanent rules                  |
| Three makeovers               | 0:12–0:24 | Newsletter (Ms. Rivera's screen), difficult email, positive-note batch; practice |
| Reaching every family         | 0:24–0:30 | The access gap; four translation rules; tone kit; the human-only list            |
| Lab: real messages            | 0:30–0:51 | Draft the real message → two passes → note batch → access plan                   |
| Making it stick               | 0:52–0:55 | Inventory; honest limits; three commitments; the month ahead                     |
| First 48 hours & close        | 0:55–0:57 | Action sheet + exit ticket                                                       |

Core session is 57 minutes. For a 45-minute slot: two diagnosis calls on slide 12, skip lab step 3 (the batch moves to the First 48 Hours sheet), two share-out voices; the script marks the cuts.

## Your 15-minute prep checklist

- ☐ **Send the staff email** (2 min, two days ahead): "Bring a charged device and the next real message you owe families (newsletter, update, reminder). You'll leave with it written."
- ☐ **Find your district's translation channel** (3 min): office, liaison, or protocol; you'll name it on slide 14.
- ☐ **Add a "Communication" section** to the staff prompt doc (1 min).
- ☐ **Skim the script once** (6 min): the makeovers on slides 9–11 and the translation rules on slide 14 are the heart; read those aloud once.
- ☐ **Click through the deck** (2 min): confirm all 30 slides display and the Ms. Rivera tracker chip shows top-right.
- ☐ **Print the handouts** (1 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours, Exit Ticket, one of each per person.

## Room, tech & timing

Same setup as Kits 1–5: projector, Wi-Fi, pair seating, a visible clock. Timing discipline: the lab must start by 0:30. Cut discussion before you ever cut the lab; the two things you never cut are slide 14 (translation rules) and slide 16 (the human-only list). Expect one strong current in the room: somebody has sent an email they regret. The 24-hour rule lands with real feeling; give it a beat.

## Facilitator FAQ

### "Can I just paste a parent's email into the tool to draft a reply?"

Strip it first. A parent's email contains names and identifying details, and Kit 1's rule covers families too: describe the situation ("a parent frustrated about a grade"), never paste the identity. The reply comes back generic; you personalize it in your own inbox.

### "Is AI translation good enough to use with families?"

For routine classroom messages, with plain-language drafting and a human check when stakes rise, it's a real access win over sending nothing a family can read. For official, legal, or rights-related documents, the answer is your district's translation channel, every time. That's also the legally safer lane, and slide 14 says so plainly.

### "Doesn't a weekly note batch feel automated?"

The batch drafts *starters*; the teacher matches each to a real kid and rewrites it personally. Kraft & Rogers' effect came from individualized messages; the personalizing step isn't optional, it's the mechanism. Say that sentence to the room.

### "What about our messaging platform's built-in AI/translation?"

District-adopted platforms follow district policy and their own agreements; today is about public general-purpose tools and the habits that transfer. Park platform questions for leadership; don't endorse or criticize a product by name.

## After the session: 5 minutes

- Collect exit tickets; they double as PD documentation.
- Skim the "communication situation I still want help with" answers; recurring ones set follow-up #2's agenda.
- Note which teams lack a translation human-check name; that's a leadership follow-up, not a teacher failure.

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